



TCM NATURAL HEALTH

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Seasonal Eating for Year-Round Wellness

Align Your Diet with Nature Using Traditional Chinese Medicine

Dr. Timothy Yeh, Ph.D., O.M.D., L.Ac.

Yeh Center of Natural Medicine

50+ Years of Clinical Experience • 500,000+ Patients Treated

A TCM Natural Health Digital Guide

Based on 4,000+ Years of Food Medicine • 20+ Years of Compiled Research

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

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Dr. Timothy Yeh is one of the most experienced natural medicine practitioners in the United States, with **over 50 years of clinical experience** bridging modern and traditional medical systems. His career spans two continents and decades of pioneering work in food medicine, herbal medicine, and acupuncture.

He studied Chinese herbal medicine and acupuncture under **Dr. Jie Hwa Ding** (grandson of the royal physician of the Qing Dynasty) and **Dr. Hwai Xuan Zhu**, chief director of the natural medical department at Xu Hui Hospital in Shanghai. He also holds a degree in chemistry from Shanghai Teacher's University.

This unique dual training gave Dr. Yeh the ability to understand food through **all three fundamental sciences: biology, chemistry, and physics**. This three-dimensional approach became the foundation of his Food Medicine theory—a system that goes far beyond nutritional labels.

Since establishing the Yeh Center in 1980, he and Dr. Pearl Yeh have **treated over 500,000 patients**, with people traveling from Europe, Asia, Latin America, and across North America. The Food Medicine book series represents over 20 years of compiled research and 4,000+ years of traditional knowledge.

"Food is a major determinant of health that is directly under our control. We cannot always control pollution, hereditary factors, or environment, but we can certainly choose what and what not to eat." —
Dr. Timothy Yeh

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

This ebook is for educational and informational purposes only. It is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease. The information is based on traditional Chinese medicine theory and Dr. Timothy Yeh's 50+ years of clinical observations.

Always consult a qualified healthcare professional before changing your diet, especially if pregnant, nursing, taking medications, or managing a health condition. TCM food therapy complements—but does not replace—professional medical advice.

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INTRODUCTION

Eating With the Seasons: A 4,000-Year Practice

In TCM, your body mirrors the natural world. Each season activates a different organ system, creates different vulnerabilities, and requires different foods to maintain balance. **Not all healthy foods are appropriate at all times.** A food that heals in winter may harm in summer.

KEY CONCEPT: Every food has an 'internal temperature'—distinct from its physical temperature. Watermelon is internally cold even at room temperature. Lamb is internally hot even when eaten cold. These temperatures interact with your organs to create balance or disharmony.

Dr. Yeh's research identified that matching your food's internal temperature to the season's energy is the single most impactful dietary change most people can make. This guide shows you exactly how.

SPRING: THE SEASON OF THE LIVER

Spring is a time of rising energy, new growth, and expansion. The liver governs smooth qi flow and emotional regulation. When balanced: creativity, motivation, emotional flexibility. When stagnant: irritability, headaches, eye problems.

Spring Eating Principles:

- Emphasize green leafy vegetables and sprouts—they mirror the season's upward energy
- Include mildly sour foods (lemon, vinegar, green apple) to support liver function
- Avoid heavy, greasy, fried foods that stagnate liver qi
- Reduce alcohol, which directly burdens the liver
- Eat lightly cooked or blanched foods rather than heavy stews

Top Spring Foods:

- **Celery** —Cool. Balances liver, clears heat, nourishes blood. Beneficial for blood pressure and dizziness.
- **Kale** — Assists the liver, benefits eyes and skin. Stir-fry with soybeans or make into soup.
- **Bok Choy** — Slightly cold. Clears heat, relieves thirst, promotes urination. Regulates stomach.
- **Chrysanthemum Tea** — Clears liver fire and eases irritability. The classic spring liver-cooling tea.
- **Mung Bean Sprouts** — Cool. Clears heat, detoxifies. Eat lightly stir-fried or in soups.
- **Shepherd's Purse** — Neutral. Regulates the spleen, stops bleeding, improves eyesight.

SPRING RECIPE: Liver-Soothing Celery Juice

Juice 1 lb of fresh celery. Drink fresh, once daily. Directly clears liver heat, lowers blood pressure, reduces dizziness. Celery has been used as medicine for nearly 3,000 years.

SUMMER: THE SEASON OF THE HEART

Summer is the peak of yang energy—maximum heat, activity, and outward expression. The primary concern is excess heat accumulating in the body, causing irritability, insomnia, dehydration, skin rashes, and digestive upset.

Summer Eating Principles:

- Favor cooling and hydrating foods to clear internal heat
- Eat lighter meals more frequently rather than heavy, large meals
- Include bitter-flavored foods—bitter clears heat from the heart
- Drink warm (not iced) water and teas to protect digestive fire
- Limit excessively spicy, fried, and alcoholic foods

Top Summer Foods:

- **Mung Bean Soup**— Cold (-10). The supreme summer heat-clearing food. Detoxifies, quenches thirst.
- **Watermelon** — Cold. Clears summer heat, generates body fluid, promotes urination.
- **Lotus Root (Raw)** — Cold (-10). Clears heat, stops bleeding, calms restlessness.
- **Water Spinach** — Cold (-7). Detoxifies, cools blood. Chlorophyll protects teeth and beautifies skin.
- **Straw Mushroom** — Cold (-10). Clears body heat, helps control blood pressure and cholesterol.
- **Purslane** — Cold (-8). Clears heat and toxins, promotes blood circulation, treats summer dysentery.

SUMMER RECIPE: Triple-Action Mung Bean Soup

Cook 60g mung beans in 4 cups water until soft. Add honey or rock sugar. Drink 1–2 cups daily throughout summer. Clears heat, detoxifies, and quenches thirst. Records of this remedy date back over 1,000 years.

AUTUMN: THE SEASON OF THE LUNGS

Autumn is associated with the lung and large intestine systems. As air dries and cools, your lungs become vulnerable to dryness. The priority: moistening and protecting the respiratory system while preparing for winter.

Autumn Eating Principles:

- Emphasize white and moist foods that nourish lungs (pear, lily bulb, white tremella, almonds)
- Reduce spicy and pungent foods that further dry the lungs
- Include fluid-generating foods: pear, honey, tofu, sesame seeds
- Begin transitioning to warm, cooked foods as temperatures drop
- Support the large intestine with fiber-rich root vegetables

Top Autumn Foods:

- **White Tremella** — Neutral. Clears lung heat, nourishes yin, improves circulation. Soak 20g, cook with red dates and honey.
- **Watercress** — Slightly cold. Moistens lungs, promotes urination. For dry cough: cook with apricot kernels.
- **Pear** — Cool. Generates fluid, moistens dryness. The classical autumn lung-protection fruit.
- **Carrot** — Neutral. Nourishes middle warmer, calms organs. Steamed carrots have 93% carotene absorption vs. 10% raw.
- **Honey** — Neutral. Moistens lungs and large intestine. Add to warm water or teas daily.

AUTUMN RECIPE: Lung-Moistening Tremella Soup

Soak 20g white tremella for 1 hour. Slow-cook overnight with 1 cup peanuts, 10 red dates, and 4 cups water. Eat for breakfast. For cardiovascular support, eat again 2 hours before bed.

WINTER: THE SEASON OF THE KIDNEYS

Winter is the time to conserve energy, build reserves, and nourish your deepest vitality. The kidneys govern aging, reproduction, bone health, and constitutional strength. **This is the most important season to eat warm, building foods.**

Winter Eating Principles:

- Focus on warming, building foods—soups, stews, bone broths, slow-cooked meals
- Include kidney-nourishing foods: black beans, walnuts, lamb, shrimp, sea cucumber
- Favor warm breakfasts (congee, oatmeal)—NEVER cold smoothies or raw cereal
- Use warming spices: ginger, cinnamon, black pepper, turmeric
- Strictly avoid cold, raw, and iced foods and drinks

Top Winter Foods:

- **Black Bean** — Warm. Invigorates kidney, nourishes blood, improves eyesight, reduces prostate swelling.
- **Lamb** — Hot (+12). The most warming common meat. Nourishes blood, warms kidney. Essential cold-weather protein.
- **Walnut** — Warm. Tonifies kidney, strengthens lower back, moistens intestines, warms the lungs.
- **Sweet Rice** — Neutral. Warms spleen and stomach, increases energy, reduces nighttime urination.
- **Shrimp** — Warm (+4). Strengthens yang, improves kidney function, promotes lactation.
- **Sea Cucumber** — Slightly cold but deeply nourishing. Tonifies kidney, replenishes essence, nourishes blood.

WINTER RECIPE: Kidney-Warming Lamb & Ginger Soup

1 lb lamb + 4 slices ginger + 5g angelica root + 4 cups water. Simmer 1 hour. Eat the meat and drink the soup. This classic formula warms the kidney, nourishes blood, and builds yang for the coldest months.

For the complete Food Medicine library: tcmnaturalhealth.com